Hao Wu

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Education

Queen Mary University of London, London, UK **2021–2026 expected**
PhD in Finance (Fully Funded PhD Scholarship)

Queen Mary University of London, London, UK **2020–2021**
MRes in Economics and Finance

University of Arizona, Tucson, US **2014–2015**
MSc in Finance (with Honours)

University of Nebraska–Lincoln, Lincoln, US **2011–2014**
B.S.B.A. in Finance (Dean's List; Beta Gamma Sigma)

Research Interests

Sustainable Finance, Climate Finance, Corporate Finance, Digital Innovation/FinTech, ESG, Green Innovation

Research Papers

Job Market Paper

• ***Digital Innovation Amplifies Sustainability: Intangible Asset Synergies and Firm Performance***

- *Draft available on SSRN and ResearchGate*

This paper examines whether digital innovation improves the financial value of corporate sustainability. Using U.S.-listed firms from 2002 to 2022, I develop a patent-based measure of digital innovation based on USPTO/CPC classifications. The findings indicate that investments in sustainability yield greater profitability and valuation improvements when integrated with high-quality digital innovation, aligning with the Productivity J-Curve framework. A Propensity Score Matching - Difference-in-Differences (PSM-DID) methodology, employing the California Global Warming Solutions Act, provides causal evidence that regulatory pressure accelerates sustainability–digital synergies, resulting in delayed valuation gains.

Working Papers

• ***The Price of Green: Policy-Induced Climate Salience and Corporate Trade-Offs***

- *Draft available on ResearchGate*

This paper studies how climate policy salience affects firms' environmental performance, innovation strategy, and valuation. Using the 2009 Regional Greenhouse Gas Initiative as a quasi-natural experiment, I apply PSM-DID design to U.S. public firms from 2006 to 2013. The results show that treated firms improve environmental performance and increase green patenting, but reduce general R&D, suggesting that climate regulation reallocates resources toward visible compliance-oriented innovation. The paper contributes to climate finance by showing that environmental regulation can stimulate targeted green innovation while crowding out broader technological exploration, especially among financially constrained firms and power-sector firms.

• ***The Informational Environment of Climate Transition Risk: Tone, Salience, and Green Innovation***

- *Draft available on ResearchGate*

This paper examines how the informational environment shapes corporate green innovation responses to transition climate risk. Using U.S. public firms from 2002 to 2017, incorporating earnings-call climate measures, Wall Street Journal attention shocks, and patent data, I find that higher transition risk is followed by lower green patenting, consistent with policy uncertainty enhancing the option value of waiting. Supportive transition tone weakens this negative relation. Shift-share tests using aggregate transition-salience shocks reveal delayed reductions in green innovation, particularly in high-impact sectors. Physical-risk and non-climate placebo tests reinforce a transition-risk interpretation.

Presentations

- Alliance for Research on Corporate Sustainability (ARCS) 18th Annual Research Conference 2026
- The International Finance and Banking Society (IFABS) London Conference 2026
- Research in Behavioral Finance Conference (RBFC) 2026
- World Finance Conference 2026
- 3rd Workshop on Recent Trends and New Developments in Sustainable, Green and International Finance 2026
- International Conference in Finance, Accounting & Banking (ICFAB) 2026
- 16th Biennial APF International Conference on Macroeconomics and Finance 2026
- Academy of Sustainable Finance, Accounting, Accountability & Governance (ASFAAG) Conference 2026
- 6th Finance and Accounting Annual Symposium 2026
- International Conference in Banking and Financial Studies (ICBFS) 2025
- QMUL Internal Seminar 2025

Teaching Experience

Queen Mary University of London

- **Principal Teaching Assistant:** Principles of Trading; Finance of Emerging Markets; International Financial Strategy
- **Teaching Assistant:** Principles of Finance; Economics and Finance in Action; Statistical Methods in Economics; Foundations of Finance

Service

- Organiser, 6th Annual PhD Workshop, School of Economics and Finance, Queen Mary University of London (2024)

Awards and Scholarships

- Fully Funded PhD Scholarship, Queen Mary University of London
- Honour Society membership
- University of Arizona Scholarship
- Benjamin F. Marshall Memorial Scholarship
- Dean's List
- Beta Gamma Sigma member

Additional Information

Computer Skills: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX
Professional: CFA Level II Candidate
Languages: English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)

Professional Experience

Industrial Bank Co., Ltd., Xi'an, China **2016–2019**
Wealth Manager / Customer Manager

References

Ilaria Piatti
Senior Lecturer in Finance, School of Economics and Finance, Queen Mary University of London
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Daniele Bianchi
Associate Professor of Finance, School of Economics and Finance, Queen Mary University of London
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Thomas Mosk
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